January 24, 1959

The snow is breathtaking today, crisp, untouched, sparkling in the weak winter sun. The mountains look like something out of a postcard, and I can't help but laugh at how small and fragile we must seem out here. I joked with the others that if anyone gets lost, the bears might adopt them as honorary cubs. They laughed, of course, though I suspect some of them didn't find it as funny as I did. I spent a little time wandering near the treeline, just watching the way the wind shifts the snow, how the pines bend under its weight. It's peaceful, almost hypnotic. But then I notice the silence, not the quiet you'd expect in the mountains, but a stillness that feels... different, as if the trees themselves are holding their breath. Maybe I'm overthinking. After all, I'm the one always joking about danger. Still, I can't shake the odd feeling that something could happen. Nothing concrete, just little things: footprints that disappear, snow that seems disturbed though no one has walked there, shadows moving too quickly. I'll chalk it up to imagination for now. The mountains are majestic, yes, but they're predictable. Or at least I keep telling myself that.

Georgiy

January 28, 1959

Yuri left today due to illness. The group seemed lighter without him, though I can't help but feel a little empty, it's strange how one person's absence can change the whole rhythm. But there's something else gnawing at me. Semyon. I can't quite put my finger on it, but he seems... off. He lingers where he shouldn't, watching quietly while the rest of us prepare for the hike. Sometimes his eyes follow us too long, and he smiles at odd moments, like he's privy to something we're not supposed to see. I try to convince myself I'm imagining it. Maybe it's the mountains playing tricks, the wind carrying sounds differently, or my own nerves. But there's a coldness to him, a detachment. I feel uncomfortable around him in a way I haven't felt with anyone else on this trip. Even small things are unsettling, the way he handles the equipment, precise, almost methodical, but not in the way you'd expect from someone who's helping. And when he talks, his words feel measured, almost rehearsed. I don't trust it. I'll have to keep my eyes open. Something about him doesn't sit right.

Georgiy

January 30, 1959

The storm is relentless. The wind tears across the snow like it's alive, and the mountains themselves feel hostile tonight. There's a heaviness pressing down on the group, something I can't name, and it gnaws at my mind. Semyon unsettles me more than ever. There's a stillness about him, a quiet calculation that chills me. He watches the others as though he knows something none of us do, and his silence feels like a warning I don't want to hear. I catch him lingering at the edge of my vision, and when I turn, he's gone, or pretending to be busy. I don't trust it. Small details are wrong, footprints that don't match anyone, noises that shouldn't exist, shadows that vanish when I look directly at them. My instincts are screaming that something is not right, and Semyon... I cannot shake the feeling that he is connected to it. I fear what may come. The snow hides things, and so do people. I must be vigilant.

Georgiy